

kind, not the aerosol. You can transfer this to another empty pump hair-spray bottle, or wait until yours is half empty. Ready? Mix it half and half with water. Yup. That's it. It works just fine when diluted by up to 50%.

If you enjoy the salon brands of hair spray (and what woman could blame you?), this will really help you maximize your product investment.

8. Astringent

Maybe all of you women out there have had better luck than I've had finding a brand of astringent that is effective enough to do the job, and yet gentle enough to not completely dry out your skin. Since that's never happened for me, I use this version.

All you need is two parts witch hazel to one part distilled water and a few drops of tea tree oil. I suppose you could skip the tea tree oil, but it works well for this, is refreshing, and allows you to adjust the recipe for those times when your skin is more oily than others. I put this in a small travel-sized squirt bottle from the pharmacy section of my favorite bargain department store, and use it with a cotton ball.

9. Hair-clarifying treatment

To give yourself a hair-clarifying treatment, mix a tiny bit of baking

soda with your shampoo in the palm of your hand. It doesn't take much. Do this at least once a week to keep the buildup off your hair and promote volume.

If you've never tried this, or it's been a while since you have, use lots of baking soda all through your hair before you shampoo. You'll need to deep-condition afterward for sure, but it's a good way to get the gook off. If you really want to not have to bother with the mixing part, you can put a tad in a separate bottle of shampoo and mark it as clarifying shampoo to use once a week or so.

A tip: Too much of the baking soda can cause a bit of drying. Start light and work your way up.

10. Scented body spray

Put two parts rubbing alcohol to one part water, and a few drops of your favorite scented oil in a spray bottle. If you'd like a little more luxury, add a bit of olive or soy oil for moisture to rub in.

Some tips on scented oils

If money is really tight for you, or you have sensitive skin, feel free to skip the scented oils. We used bits of our weekly and monthly savings to slowly accumulate a collection of various essential oils. My favorite kind is the generic brand that many health-food